

EMERGENCY TOOL

THE QUICK-FLARE ACTION CARD

Your Immediate Response Plan for Foot Pain Flares

CHASE THE DATA, NOT THE SENSATION.

The Flare Recovery Playbook | Dr. Jonathan Schutza, PT, DPT

When a Flare Hits — First 24 Hours

Follow this action plan immediately

STOP Activities That Increase Pain

STOP High-impact activities (running, jumping)

STOP Prolonged standing (>30 min)

STOP Walking barefoot on hard surfaces

STOP Wearing unsupportive shoes

1. Relative Rest (Not Complete Rest)

Reduce activity by 50-70%. Keep moving gently to prevent stiffness.

TODAY'S ACTIVITY LEVEL (0-10)

PAIN LEVEL (0-10)

2. Ice or Contrast Therapy

Ice: 15-20 min, 3-4x/day | Contrast: 3 min ice, 1 min warm, repeat 3x

TIME OF ICE/CONTRAST

PAIN AFTER (0-10)

3. Gentle Mobility (Pain-Free Range Only)

Ankle circles, toe spreads, gentle calf stretches — stop if pain increases.

MOBILITY EXERCISES DONE

PAIN DURING (0-10)

4. Footwear Check

Wear supportive shoes with good cushioning. Avoid flats and high heels.

SHOES WORN TODAY

COMFORT RATING (1-10)

24-Hour Flare Tracker

DATE	MORNING PAIN (0-10)	EVENING PAIN (0-10)
TRIGGER IDENTIFIED		

Notes & Observations